

RAJENDRA PRASAD N

LEAD GITLAB & DEVOPS ENGINEER | CI/CD, DEVSECOPS, TERRAFORM & KUBERNETES

rajendran.scm@gmail.com
+1 (469) 926-4201
Dallas, TX
linkedin.com/in/rajendranlakurthi
rajendranlakurthi.github.io

Lead GitLab and DevOps Engineer with more than a decade of enterprise platform, release engineering, cloud infrastructure, and production operations experience. Hands-on expertise administering GitLab delivery workflows, migrating Azure DevOps and Jenkins pipelines to GitLab CI/CD, operating self-hosted and autoscaling runners, building reusable pipeline templates, and enforcing branch protection, merge, approval, artifact, and repository governance standards. Experienced implementing **GitLab Duo** for AI-assisted development with security, review, and adoption guardrails. Deep strength in **Linux, shell automation, Terraform, AWS, Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, EKS, OpenShift, and DevSecOps controls**, with experience supporting GPU-enabled and vector-search platforms for AI-oriented workloads. Proven record improving pipeline security, reliability, scalability, and developer delivery efficiency.

CERTIFICATIONS



GitLab Certified Associate



Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals



Microsoft Certified: Azure DevOps Engineer Expert



AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate



MuleSoft Certified Developer - Level 1

KEY PLATFORM ACHIEVEMENTS

- AWS Platform Engineering** Designed AWS-first infrastructure with Terraform, CloudFormation, and Ansible to standardize provisioning, improve repeatability, and support secure multi-environment delivery.
- Observability** Implemented CloudWatch, Prometheus, Grafana, Splunk, ELK, and custom telemetry pipelines to improve platform visibility, incident response, and operational diagnosis.
- DevSecOps & Governance** Integrated security scanning, policy-driven controls, IAM, MFA, and secure network patterns into CI/CD and cloud operations to strengthen delivery governance and compliance.
- Release Engineering** Directed enterprise release orchestration, build automation, change governance, and deployment troubleshooting across AWS, Kubernetes, and mission-critical application platforms.
- Kubernetes Platforms** Delivered containerized workloads on EKS, OpenShift, Rancher, and self-managed Kubernetes environments using Helm, ArgoCD, and repeatable manifest-driven workflows.

CORE TECHNOLOGIES

CI/CD PLATFORMS

GitLab, GitLab CI/CD, GitLab Duo, GitLab Runners, Jenkins, AWS CodePipeline, AWS CodeBuild, AWS CodeDeploy, CloudBees, ArgoCD

INFRASTRUCTURE AS CODE

Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, Packer, YAML pipelines, AWS CLI

SOURCE CONTROL & SCM

GitLab, GitHub, Bitbucket, Gerrit, Subversion, TFS

CLOUD PLATFORMS

AWS, Linode, multi-account landing zones, VPC, Transit Gateway, VPN, Direct Connect, Route 53, ALB, NLB, CloudFront

OPERATING SYSTEMS

Linux, RHEL, Ubuntu, HP-UX, Windows Server 2012

CONTAINERS & ORCHESTRATION

Docker, Docker Swarm, ECS, Kubernetes, Helm, Istio, Consul

MONITORING & LOGGING

Amazon CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Grafana, Prometheus, AppDynamics, Splunk, ELK, Fluentd, InfluxDB

SCRIPTING & PROGRAMMING

Shell, Batch, Python, PowerShell, .NET (C#), Core Java

BUILD TOOLS

ANT, Maven, MSBuild, Make, Gradle

MANAGED KUBERNETES

EKS, OpenShift, Rancher, self-managed Kubernetes, hybrid Kubernetes

DATABASES & RELEASE TOOLS

MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Amazon RDS, Amazon Aurora, Liquibase, JFrog, SonarQube, Fortify, Black Duck

OTHER PLATFORMS

IIS, Apache Tomcat, JBoss, WebLogic, VMware ESXi, Vagrant, Hyper-V, Vault, datree.io, Amazon ECR

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead DevOps Engineer | AT&T Services Inc.

08/2023 - Present

Skills Used: AWS, GitLab, GitLab CI/CD, GitLab Duo, Git, Terraform, EKS, Docker, Helm, Bash, Python

- Led the migration of source repositories and delivery pipelines from Azure DevOps to GitLab, defining phased cutover plans, repository mappings, access controls, validation gates, and rollback procedures to protect active development streams.
- Implemented GitLab Duo capabilities across software delivery workflows, enabling AI-assisted code generation, code explanation, test creation, merge request summaries, vulnerability remediation, and developer adoption guardrails.
- Monitored runner capacity, pipeline duration, failure trends, queue time, cache efficiency, and deployment health to improve GitLab platform reliability and developer productivity.
- Integrated GitLab DevSecOps controls into pipelines, including secret detection, dependency and container scanning, SAST, IaC validation, security gates, and policy-driven merge approvals.
- Built Terraform modules and GitLab CI/CD workflows to provision AWS networking, IAM, EKS, compute, storage, and supporting platform services through repeatable, version-controlled infrastructure changes.
- Implemented AWS authentication for GitLab pipelines using short-lived role-based credentials and controlled environment variables, reducing reliance on long-lived cloud access keys.
- Created GitLab platform standards, migration playbooks, runner troubleshooting guides, branching documentation, and operational runbooks for engineering and support teams.
- Architected reusable GitLab CI/CD pipeline templates with parent-child and multi-project pipelines, rules-based execution, environment promotion, artifact retention, caching, and controlled manual approvals.
- Established GitLab Duo governance covering approved use cases, access controls, data-handling expectations, human review requirements, adoption metrics, and enablement guidance for development teams.
- Standardized Docker image build, scan, versioning, and promotion workflows through GitLab pipelines and deployed containerized services to Amazon EKS using Helm and Kubernetes manifests.
- Automated GitLab repository and pipeline administration with Bash and Python, including project bootstrap, variable configuration, runner registration, policy enforcement, and migration validation.
- Administered GitLab groups, projects, repositories, protected branches, merge request rules, approval policies, CODEOWNERS, deploy tokens, access tokens, and role-based permissions across enterprise engineering teams.
- Provisioned and operated self-managed GitLab runners on AWS using autoscaling, tagging, protected-runner policies, isolated execution, cache optimization, and workload-specific runner pools for secure, high-throughput builds.
- Designed Git branching strategies covering feature, release, hotfix, and trunk-based workflows, with protected-branch controls and merge standards aligned to release governance and audit requirements.
- Designed secure Terraform delivery with remote state, state locking, reusable modules, plan and apply separation, protected environments, approval gates, and least-privilege AWS IAM roles.

Senior DevOps Engineer | GlobalLogic

03/2023 - 08/2023

Skills Used: AWS, GitLab CI, Terraform, Jira, Kubernetes

- Migrated Jenkins pipelines to GitLab CI and modernized runner configuration to improve maintainability and pipeline reliability.
- Improved Kubernetes release processes by standardizing deployment patterns, secure runner standards, controlled branch protections, container image validation, and pipeline checks across environments.
- Created package views, artifact feeds, and upstream repository strategies aligned to application team delivery requirements.
- Managed Docker image build, provisioning, and runtime administration to standardize containerized delivery workflows.
- Implemented GitLab CI best practices, including reusable templates, pipeline governance, and controlled branch-based execution.
- Enforced SCM best practices and coached development teams on GitLab workflows, branch governance, and merge standards.
- Troubleshot pipeline, container, and Kubernetes issues in partnership with development teams to accelerate delivery and reduce deployment failures.
- Deployed and administered self-hosted and auto-scaling build agents for Linux and Windows workloads supporting CI/CD and release automation.
- Configured agent pools, runner templates, and execution policies to improve build reliability and reduce manual pipeline support.
- Administered Kubernetes clusters and deployed applications through pods, deployments, services, and core platform components.

Senior DevOps Engineer II | Akamai Technologies

12/2021 - 03/2023

Skills Used: AWS, Linode, Python, Terraform, EKS, GitHub Actions, GitLab

- Built dashboards for CI/CD pipelines, work items, and defect tracking to improve engineering visibility and release governance.
- Provisioned AWS infrastructure using CloudFormation, Terraform, and pipeline-driven infrastructure-as-code deployment patterns.
- Established and maintained CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins, Git, Amazon ECR, and Kubernetes for repeatable application delivery.
- Drove continuous integration and continuous delivery practices using Git, Maven, Jenkins, Ansible, Docker, Kubernetes, and AWS services.
- Deployed and configured self-hosted runners and build agents for Linux and Windows workloads supporting CI/CD and release automation.
- Integrated delivery tooling with Slack, Microsoft Teams, Jenkins, GitHub, and SonarQube based on engineering and audit requirements.
- Authored PowerShell and shell automation scripts and published them to shared repositories for consistent reuse across environments.
- Implemented GitHub Actions workflows for deploying services to Kubernetes clusters across multiple environments.
- Troubleshot build and release pipeline failures and resolved deployment issues across distributed engineering teams.
- Implemented disaster recovery, backup, and observability controls using AWS Elastic Disaster Recovery, AWS Backup, and Amazon CloudWatch.
- Designed secure VPC networking, Route 53 DNS, security groups, load balancing, VPN connectivity, Direct Connect, and traffic-routing patterns for enterprise workloads.
- Deployed Kubernetes microservices through ArgoCD-based GitOps workflows.
- Built Docker images and deployed containerized applications to EKS using Helm charts and Kubernetes manifests.
- Published versioned artifacts to enterprise repositories and package managers to support downstream engineering consumption and traceability.
- Configured deployment groups and environment-specific release targets to streamline controlled production rollouts.

Senior DevOps Engineer / Senior SRE | Turvo India Pvt Ltd

04/2020 - 12/2021

Skills Used: AWS, Python, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, SonarQube, JFrog, Terraform, Kubernetes, Prometheus, Ansible

- Designed CI/CD pipelines for application and infrastructure deployments across AWS environments.
- Standardized GitHub Actions-based CI/CD patterns to accelerate software delivery and reduce pipeline drift across teams.
- Applied platform engineering best practices to improve reliability, scalability, and operational efficiency across shared services.
- Administered CloudBees Jenkins, JFrog Artifactory, and Xray enterprise tooling for secure software delivery.
- Implemented MFA, identity access controls, and role-based access management for users and groups across cloud environments.
- Designed and delivered a Terraform and Kubernetes solution for payment-platform deployments, enabling repeatable infrastructure provisioning and container orchestration.
- Created architecture and resource diagrams to support compliance reviews, security sign-offs, and controlled release execution.
- Authored and enforced custom policy controls aligned to internal security and governance requirements across AWS accounts.
- Partnered with peers to isolate product defects and participated in retrospectives with development teams and sprint managers to improve release quality.
- Automated onboarding of new projects to the enterprise DevOps platform through API-driven workflows.
- Developed internal APIs in Python FastAPI to integrate Jenkins, Jira, and JFrog processes with platform automation.
- Developed custom Prometheus exporters in Python to capture application-specific operational metrics for SRE use cases.
- Built resilient Ansible roles and playbooks to deploy highly available Grafana, Prometheus, and Node Exporter monitoring stacks.
- Authored Helm charts to deploy containerized applications consistently across Kubernetes environments.
- Developed Jenkins shared libraries to automate image versioning and publish artifacts to private JFrog repositories.

Senior DevOps Engineer | HCL Technologies

02/2019 - 04/2020

Client: Mercedes-Benz Research & Development India

Skills Used: Kubernetes, AWS, Ansible, GitHub, Shell Scripting, Jenkins, Maven, Tomcat, JBoss, Helm

- Represented the DevOps team and presented CI/CD and infrastructure automation strategies for key engineering initiatives, including Model Finder.
- Worked extensively with AWS infrastructure services including EC2, CloudWatch, Secrets Manager, and managed database platforms for enterprise workloads.
- Built continuous delivery pipelines and supported REST-based microservices deployments across Demo, Test, Pentest, Training, CTDEV, Sandbox, UAT, and PROD environments.
- Led platform review discussions with stakeholders in Germany to present roadmap enhancements and quarterly DevOps priorities.
- Supported enterprise applications on AWS by troubleshooting CloudWatch, Amazon RDS, load balancing, auto scaling, certificate management, CloudFront, and identity integrations.
- Automated fleet-level configuration enforcement for Linux and Windows EC2 instances and managed secure access and database connectivity in line with enterprise security standards.
- Designed monitoring architecture to collect application, infrastructure, and platform metrics using the ELK stack.
- Used CloudFormation and PowerShell scripting to provision and manage cloud resources in a repeatable and auditable manner.
- Planned and executed migration strategies for traditional workloads to AWS using lift-and-shift and modernization approaches.
- Integrated on-premises identity sources with cloud access controls and strengthened security using privileged access, identity protection, and MFA.
- Supported migration of on-premises Windows Server workloads to AWS and validated post-migration configuration through structured cutover and failover testing.
- Tuned scaling policies and service capacity for application and database workloads during on-premises to AWS migration programs.
- Deployed Kubernetes manifests to on-premises clusters with Helm and standardized release packaging across services.
- Served as acting scrum master by managing stories, epics, sprint commitments, and core scrum ceremonies.
- Built Kubernetes environments with pods, deployments, services, and ConfigMaps, and managed Helm-based release packaging for multi-namespace workloads.

DevOps Engineer | Mphasis Ltd

08/2016 - 12/2018

Client: HPE

Skills Used: AWS, Chef, Ansible, GitLab, Shell Scripting, Python, Maven, Tomcat, JBoss, Splunk, Nexus

- Created CI/CD pipelines for multiple application components across shared delivery platforms.
- Defined and implemented branching strategies for Git repositories to improve release governance and code promotion.
- Created deployment pipelines with Ansible to promote releases from development through production in a controlled, repeatable manner.
- Built YAML-based build and release pipelines with event-driven triggers to support continuous integration on every code change.
- Authored and maintained Terraform modules and executed infrastructure changes through automated CI/CD workflows.
- Executed AWS proof-of-concepts and delivered solution designs aligned to application and infrastructure requirements.
- Authored AWS CLI automation to update service configurations and standardize administrative operations.
- Documented build and deployment flows for core infrastructure, API, database, and UI components to improve team consistency.
- Executed Terraform deployments through pipelines and promoted the same artifact set across multiple environments through controlled environment selection.
- Built and managed self-hosted build agents to support pipeline execution at scale.
- Managed variable groups and environment-specific configuration to separate deployments cleanly across stages.

EDUCATION

B.Tech (2009-2013) in Information Technology

Prakasam Engineering College, Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Kakinada